

AGENDA: WEEK FIVE

Revised 9/25

Welcome Back to the 4th Step Workshop

Congratulations! Good job for making the decision to take on your own life!

1. Please join us in the Serenity Prayer

2. Introductions all around

3. Housekeeping Items...

- If the door is closed before 7 pm, we are doing some prep work
- Please silence your cell phone
- Different 12 step groups are represented here tonight, so please be considerate
- Speak loudly and clearly so all can hear what you have to share
- Raise your hand if you can't hear others or the Facilitators
- Circulate attendance sheet (for our use)
- We pass the basket to help cover cost for workshop space rental, materials, etc
- Suggested donation is \$20 for entire workshop (only if able)
- Bathrooms are down the hall all the way on your right
- Ask for help putting tables back & chairs away (need 16 left out)

4. Discussion Topics

- **Any questions about last week's assignments?**
- **Did everyone get caught up?**
- **This week there is a lot of homework so schedule time each day**
- **Remember to call Sponsors and Facilitators if you have questions**

5. Check in with regard to 5th step appointments.

- Any questions regarding 5th step appointments?
- Remember to set aside the whole day
- Does anyone not have appointment set?
- If you don't have an appointment be sure to talk to a facilitator after tonight's workshop.
- Reminder – Dates are Thursday _____ to Monday _____
- Most important thing is to set up your 5th Step as soon as you can

6. First half of this week's assignment is columns 3 and 4 of the Harms Sheet if you haven't finished them.

- **Remember to use your Glossary**
- **Work columns top to bottom**

7. Big Book Reading (Page 69, paragraph 1 through Page 70, paragraph 2)

We reviewed our own conduct over the years past. Where had we been selfish, dishonest or inconsiderate? Whom had we hurt? Did we unjustifiably arouse jealousy, suspicion or bitterness? Where were we at fault, what should we have done instead? We got this all down on paper and looked at it.

In this way we tried to shape a sane and sound ideal for our future sex life. We subjected each relation to this test – was it selfish or not? We asked God to mold our ideas and help us to live up to them. We remembered always that our sex powers were God-given and therefore good, neither to be used lightly or selfishly nor to be despised and loathed.

Whatever our ideal turns out to be, we must be willing to grow toward it. We must be willing to make amends where we have done harm provided that we do not bring about still more harm in doing so. In other words, we treat sex as we would any other problem. In meditation, we ask God what we should do about each specific matter. Counsel with persons is often desirable, but we let God be the final judge. We realize that some people are as fanatical about sex as others are loose. We avoid hysterical thinking or advice.

Suppose we fall short of the chosen ideal and stumble? Does this mean we are going to get drunk? Some people tell us so. But this is only a half-truth. It depends on us and on our motives. If we are sorry for what we have done, and have the honest desire to let God take us to better things, we believe we will be forgiven and will have learned our lesson. If we are not sorry, and our conduct continues to harm others, we are quite sure to drink. We are not theorizing. These are facts out of our experience.

To sum up about sex: we earnestly pray for the right ideal, for guidance in each questionable situation, for sanity, and for the strength to do the right thing. If sex is very troublesome, we throw ourselves the harder into helping others. We think of their needs and work for them. This takes us out of ourselves. It quiets the imperious urge, when to yield would mean heartache.

8. (VANA) [Ask participants to] pull out your handout entitled **Guidelines** for Summaries

- Read top paragraph of Guidelines.
- Read the Instructions, 1-5.
- Work instruction steps **1 through 5** of Guidelines with **Resentment** examples
- Questions?
- Work through more **Resentment** examples
- Questions? Do you need to hear more examples?

- [Read the **Fears** and **Harms** examples ???]
- 12 different summaries (4 defects of character for 3 worksheets)
- Cannot repeat - explain
- **Must** call (or text & ask for a callback) a Facilitator after you write first Summary to make sure you are on the right track

9. Pull out handout: Suggested Preparation for 5th Step

- Read through all bullet points
- If you don't have a copy of the Big Book, the suggested reading can be found on the Internet or the free App "Everything AA"

10. Discussion about *Questions* and *Answers* used for 5th Step

- Make clear when to read (After quiet hour)
- Next week please don't share contents of the documents
- Commend them for coming this far
- Don't stop now!
- Writing the Summaries are where you will see a shift
- Keep all this work for future steps

11. Questions

12. Assignment:

- **Column 3 & 4 of Harms TOP TO BOTTOM** (if not already completed)
- **12 summaries (which must be completed BEFORE doing your 5th Step)**
- **Must** call a Facilitator after writing the first one
- **Confirm 5th Step Appointments**
- **Call your Sponsor**
- **Use the Phone list and call or text Facilitators**

13. **"Please join us in the Serenity Prayer"**

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